

I. SIX BASIC DOCUMENTS (1-6)

This chapter presents some records that deal with basic elements of Elamma's commercial activity: his assets, capital and investments, relating to what he inherited from his father and his own joint-stock capital (*naruqqum*). In addition a few documents dealing with investments in such funds and in some "caravans" (*ellutum*), and concerning his cooperation with his (elder) brother Ali-ahum, which involves assets of their "paternal house".

1. Kt 91/k 347 (1-204-91)

A witnessed protocol of a confrontation between Elamma and his elder brother Ali-ahum, caused by the latter's managing of the property, left behind by their father Iddin-Suen, without duly considering the interests of his brother. It must have taken place after their father had died in Assur, where Ali-ahum lived or happened to be, while Elamma was in Anatolia.

	2 GÚ 40 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B.	Two talents and 40 minas of silver,
	5 <i>li-me</i> ŠE-um 30 DUG	5000 measures of barley, 30 jars
	ù 40 DUG : <i>ba-áb-tám</i>	plus 40 jars outstanding claims;
	<i>i-na a-lim^{ki}</i> : 10 <i>šu-ba-tim</i>	in the City a plot of 10 <i>šubātum</i> ,
5	<i>qá-qí-[r]i</i> : É- <i>tám</i> : <i>ep-ša-am</i>	a built house,
	É * <i>Dí-°la₂?</i> -a : 60 TÚG.HI.A	the house of Dilaya(?); 60 textiles,
	<i>e-pí-š[u]</i> <i>ša-na-tim</i>	rugs, pitchers,
	<i>sí-pá-°r₂*i</i> : ú <i>sú-ub*-ra-am</i>	bronze objects and slaves -
	<i>ša É a-bi-ni</i> : <i>zu-a-za-am</i>	the estate of our father which we
10	<i>qá-bi-a-ni-ni</i> : <i>a-na</i>	have promised / been ordered to divide.
	<i>a-i-tim</i> : <i>ba-lu-a</i>	Why have you suppressed (it)
	<i>ta-ak-bu-ús</i>	without me?
l.e.	<i>um-ma A-lá-hu-um-ma</i>	Ali-ahum answered:
rev.	<i>a-šu-mì e-li-tí-a</i>	"In order to prevent my
15	ù <i>e-li-tí-kà</i>	and your extra share from being
	<i>la ha-a-ṭim ak-bu-ús</i>	inspected I have suppressed it."
	<i>um-ma E-la-ma-ma</i>	Elamma answered: "If only I could
	<i>e-li-tí-ma-mì-in</i>	have taken along my own
	<i>lu-bi-il-ma</i> : <i>i-na É</i>	extra share and had obtained
20	<i>a-bi-a</i> : <i>zi-tí</i> : <i>lá-zu-úz-ma</i>	my share in my father's estate,
	KÙ.GI 1 GÚ : <i>a-na u₄-mì-im</i>	then by this day I would have
	<i>a-nim</i> : <i>kà-áš-da-ku-mì-in</i>	had at my disposal one talent of gold!
	<i>ki-ma ik-bu-sa¹-ni-ni</i>	That he repressed me, I wish to retain
	<i>ša ni-iš</i> : <i>a-lim^{ki}</i>	as (a statement) made
25	<i>ta-mu-ú</i> : <i>lu ú-kà-al</i>	with an oath by the City!"
	IGI <i>E-dí-na-a</i>	In the presence of Eddināya,
u.e.	IGI <i>En-um-A-šūr</i>	and of Ennum-Aššur.

Notes

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The text was edited in Veenhof 2011, with evidence for my interpretation and translation. I mention here only what is essential for its understanding as a source on the assets of Elamma and the relation between the two brothers.

2-3. The mention of DUG = *karputum*, “jar”, a measure of capacity of ca. 30 litres, suggests that “5000 measures” of l. 1 were also rather “jars” than “bags” (*naruqqum*, equal to 4 “jars”).

4-5. The OA surface measure *šubtum* is probably equals one *musārûm* or ca. 36 m². The large size suggests a plot of land in the city (with *qaqqurû* in apposition), with a house built on it.

9-10. The words “we had promised / been ordered to divide” (both translations are possible), without a reference to their father’s testament, suggests that it did not exist and that mediators or arbiters had worked out a fair division.

12-16, 23. The verb *kabāsum*, basically “to step on”, in OA is used in a variety of meanings in specific contexts (see CAD K, 9, meaning 4, a-c). The precise meaning of its use here, without object, is unclear; my “suppressed” derives from Ali-ahum’s claim that he did so to prevent their *elītu*-shares from undergoing “inspection, checks” (*ha’āṭum*; for taxation?) by the Assyrian authorities. *Kabāsum* in line 23, with a personal accusative object, makes Elamma the victim of this action, whereby his brother (line 11, “without me”) violated his interests.

14-15. While the normal share in the inheritance of the “paternal house” - “domestic” assets, such as the building, its furniture, slaves, bronze objects, stocks, and cash silver – is called *zittum* in l. 20, *elītum* probably refers to additional commercial “assets”, such as investments and claims on agents and debtors, merchandise in transit, etc., frequently represented by relevant records. The exact size of the latter was usually unknown at the time the testament was written and had to be established by collecting evidence and settling accounts.

23-25. See for this expression, in which *ka’ulum* means “to keep in mind”, the discussion in OALP 215-219, but I have doubts about the translation “I wish to retain (this) *for* (italics mine, K.R.V.) the oath of the City”.

Comment

Elamma was angry because his elder brother, notwithstanding the order or promise to divide their father’s inheritance, had denied him access to and use of his share. He asked him before witnesses why he did so and so acquired a witnesses protocol that not only contained the answer, but also listed the assets of the paternal house and confirmed the obligation to carry out a division. At the end it recorded his frustration, asserting that he had been denied the use a capital of no less than one talent of gold. He underscores it by means of an oath (lines 23-25) that uses a formula known from dozens of judicial records, spoken in the presence of the mediators, presumably in view of possible legal action, if his brother does not satisfy him. We do not know how this conflict ended, but his brother probably soon gave him what he was entitled to, since neither in Elamma’s archive, nor in that of his brother (Kt 93/k, to be edited by C. Michel) is there any evidence for a subsequent legal fight. After the death of their father, following the pattern outlined in Larsen 2007, both brothers had their own “firm” and joint-stock capital and lived in *kārum* Kanesh in separate houses, opposite each other in the same street. But they did cooperate and had shares in each other’s joint-stock capital; *3:8f. mentions a share of 1 mina of gold invested by Elamma in his brother’s joint-stock capital and *2:2 a share of 2 minas of gold of Ali-ahum in that of Elamma’s. Interesting is the mention in *3:24ff. of “silver of the paternal house (É A.BA) which is (part of) the joint-stock capital of Ali-ahum”, of which Elamma and

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Ali-ahum each own a part (*qātum*). It suggests that some of the investments left behind by their father were still jointly owned, which is confirmed by *2:7f., which mentions a share in Elamma's joint-stock capital jointly owned by him and his brother. Perhaps the shares they had in each other's joint-stock funds were not investments actually made, but shares registered in their names in consequence of a division of their father's capital.

How could Elamma have survived as trader "until this day" (lines 20f.) without having obtained his share in the inheritance? Unfortunately we do not know when his father died, but it was probably rather early, because he does not play an active role in the texts of Elamma's archive. We know that Elamma was already active in eponymy year 67, when according to *74:15-19 he gave credit to Aššur-dūrī (proved to be a claim of Elamma by *69:28-35). And in eponymy year 78, according to *2, he acquired his own joint-stock fund (*naruqqum*), brought together by a number of investors, which implies that by then he was already an experienced and trusted trader. But of course, what Elamma inherited from his father helped him to establish this position. The shares in gold Elamma himself invested in the *naruqqu*-fund, 1 mina 12 shekels, owned jointly by him and his brother and 3 minas 45 shekels of him alone, may very well derive from the enormous amount of silver left behind by his father, for such shares in gold were always acquired by contributing silver that was converted in gold at a rate of 1:4. And the assets designated in the joint-stock contract as "my cash (capital)" (*šalfī*), consisting of "1500 measures of barley, 2 slaves, the share and the pots", may be related to the large amounts of barley, slaves and "my share", mentioned in our protocol, while the assets called "pots" could perhaps be or range under the *elītum* of our text.

2. Kt 91/k 482 (1-335-91)

A copy (no witnesses are mentioned!) of the contract of Elamma's joint-stock fund (*naruqqum*) from eponymy year REL 78.

2 1/2 ma-na GUŠKIN I-li-a	2 1/2 mins of gold Iliya,
2 ma-na A-la-hu-um	2 minas Ali-ahum,
2 ma-na Šu-La-ba-an	2 minas Šu-Labān,
1 1/3 ma-na Ku-ni-la	1 1/3 mina Kunila,
5 DUMU.MUNUS En-nam-A-šūr	daughter of Ennam-Aššur,
1 2/3 ma-na DAM.GÀR-ru-um	1 2/3 mina <i>tamkārum</i> ,
1 ma-na 12 GÍN A-la-hu-um	1 mina 12 shekels Ali-ahum
ù E-la-ma	and Elamma,
1 ma-na 12 GÍN A-mur-Ištar ŠEŠ-šu	1 mina 12 shekels his brother Amur-Ištar,
10 1 ma-na ša na-ru-uq A-mur-Ištar	1 mina of the <i>naruqqum</i> of Amur-Ištar,
1 ma-na 12 GÍN ša-li-sú	1 mina 12 shekels his cash funds,
1 1/2 ma-na ša na-ru-qí-šu	1 1/2 mina of his <i>naruqqum</i>
Hi-na-a 3 1/2 ma-na	Hinnāya, 3 1/2 minas
i.e. DAM.GÀR-ru-um	<i>tamkārum</i> ,
15 3 ma-na DAM.GÀR-ru-um	3 minas <i>tamkārum</i> ,
rev. 2 ma-na DAM.GÀR-ru-um	2 minas <i>tamkārum</i> ,
3 2/3 ma-na 5 GÍN E-lá-/ma	3 3/4 minas Elamma -
ŠU.NIGIN 27 5/6 ma-na 1 GÍN	in all 27 5/6 minas 1 shekel

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	GUŠKIN <i>na-ru-uq E-lá-ma</i>	of gold enters the joint-stock fund
20	<i>e-ra-áb i-na nè-mì-lim</i>	of Elamma. Of the profit
	<i>ša-al-ša-tim e-kà-al</i>	he will enjoy one third,
	<i>a-na ša-al-ša-tim i-za-az</i>	one third he will guarantee.
	<i>a-na MU.10.ŠÈ ni-kà-sí</i>	In 10 years he will
	<i>i-da-an ša i-lá u₄-me-šu</i>	render account. Who asks for
25	<i>ma-al-ú-tim ší-ip-kà-tí-/šu</i>	his investment before its due date
	<i>e-ri-šu 4 ma-na.TA i-lá-qé</i>	will receive 4 minas per (mina of gold).
	<i>1 li-im 5 me-at ŠE</i>	1500 measures of barley,
	<i>2 sú-ub-ru-um</i>	2 slaves, the share (in the inheritance)
rev.	<i>zi-tum lu ku-ur-sí-na/tum</i>	and (what is in) the various 'pots' -
	<i>i.e. mī-ma a-nim ša-al-tí li-mu-um</i>	all this is my available capital. Eponymy
31	<i>lb-ni^d IŠKUR DUMU Ba-qú-ni-im</i>	of Ibni-Adad, son of Baqqunum.

Comments

Since shares in joint-stock ventures could be inherited, some of the odd figures (1 mina 12 shekels, 1 1/3 mina, 1 2/3 mina) must refer to parts of larger shares that were divided between heirs. The one of 1 mina 12 shekels, owned jointly by Elamma and his brother, probably represented 1/5 of a share of 6 minas of gold (owned by their father?), the more so since also Amur-lštar, another son of Iddin-Suen, had a such a share and another share, designated as "his cash" (*šalissu*), has the same seize. The odd figure of the total, 27 minas 51 shekels of gold, is also remarkable and must have made accounting and dividing the profit rather difficult. One wonders why Elamma's own share was not made slightly bigger to arrive at a round figure.

The assets of lines 29-30 remind us of text 1, the protocol about what Elamma and his brother inherited from their father. See for an analysis of the meaning *kursīnum* Veenhof 2012a, 190-193, where I concluded: "*kursīnum*, especially in the plural, must have originally denoted jars in which specific items (goods, "money", and perhaps also the records relating to them), belonging or referring to particular persons, originating from specific transactions, or reserved for special purposes, were kept. Somehow marked for their contents or ownership they may have served as a practical system of storage and classification, but soon the term, just like *naruqqum*, must have acquired a metaphoric, more technical meaning to refer to "smaller funds" of various nature, which were basically accounting units and could count as assets of a family or firm and from which (also cash?) payments could be made". See the note on *175:7.

The contents and structure of the two available joint-stock fund contracts were analyzed by Larsen 1977 and 1999. A comparison of Elamma's contract (E) with that of Amur-lštar = KayMus 313 (A; see now also Hecker 1999, text 1, with some improved readings)¹ is instructive. E's term, 10 years, is similar to the 12 years of A (an unpublished third contract in Ankara, in the Kt n/k archive, has a term of 9 years) and E's capital, nearly 28 minas of gold, is comparable to the 30 minas of gold of A. The terminology is largely the same, but while E states that the capital "enters Elamma's joint-stock fund" (19f.), in A it is simply called "A's joint-stock fund". Moreover, E adds a stipulation about a settlement of accounts between investors and tractator (*nikkassī tadānum*, only occurrence of this expression). While E and A both

¹ Study of the original in Kayseri showed that after line 1 one line is missing and destroyed; it must have named the first and main investor.

state how much an investor gets in the case of premature withdrawal of his capital, A adds "he will not receive any of the profit". E at the end simply mentions the year the contract was drawn up, A. adds that he will trade (*makārum*) for twelve years. Before the date E mentions the composition and size of Elamma's "cash capital" (*šaltum*), which may have served as a kind of security and given his investors trust in his financial situation.

We meet a variety of investors but, different from A, several of them are anonymous, recorded as *tamkārum*, "the creditor", "the owner". This may have been done, as several sources show, to facilitate the cession or sale of such shares, to keep their ownership secret, and occasionally also because it was disputed or unclear, especially in connection with the division of an inheritance. Interesting is AKT 1, 68 (Kt a/k 466), because it deals with the joint-stock fund of Amur-lštar, son of Iddin-Suen, a brother of Elamma and also one of his investors (see above lines 9-11): "1 ½ mina of gold Aššur-idī gave to Amur-lštar for the *naruqqum*. He will go and in the City he will inscribe in his joint-stock fund contract 1½ mina of gold in the name of *tamkārum*. The gold belongs to Aššur-idī; the list/share of the joint-stock fund has been made/realized".² Similarly, Kt a/k 494 (Dercksen 1996, note 298), "the 2 minas of gold that have been marked in Puzur-Aššur's *naruqqum* as (belonging to) *tamkārum*, that gold belongs to Adad-šulūlī, Adad-šulūlī is the *tamkārum*".³ Both texts show that in such cases it was essential to have a valid record identifying the owner. Why so many shares in Elamma's contract are in the name of *tamkārum* is unknown.

Two of the investors, Ali-ahum and Amur-lštar, were brothers of Elamma, proof of cooperation between members of one family. The way in which the investment of Hinnāya (l. 12f.), a close business associate who occurs frequently in the archive, is listed is abnormal. Does "1 ½ mina of his joint-stock fund, H.", mean that H. invested money from his own fund in that of Elamma, or rather "1½ mina of his (Elamma's) joint-stock fund: Hinnāya"? Iliya, without patronym, is a merchant in Assur, one of the associates or representatives of Elamma there, known from several letters (*3:1, *6:4, and *39:1) as recipient of silver in *12:5; *20:15) and engaged in the trade of textiles (*9:15, *129:2, *54:11, etc.). Šu-Labān, considering the early date of this contract, could be the father of the well-known trader Imdīlum, but there is also a Šu-Labān, son of Ibni-ilī, witness in *307:2 (dated by a single, presumably rather early week-eponym, who occurs only here). It is interesting to see a woman as shareholder, a daughter of Ennum-Aššur, also a business associate of Elamma. Had her father given her a share or had she inherited it, as a daughter of Pūšu-kēn had?

3. Kt 91/k 355 (1-212-9)

His representatives in Assur inform Elamma on various purchases made, for which they used also silver deriving from his joint-stock capital. The end reports that Aššur-tāb – the name of a son of Elamma and of a son of his brother Ali-ahum – had

² *Qá-tí na-ru-qí-im / e-pí-iš* (which the case omits). The translation given above is possible, because there are a few more examples of *qātum* followed by a 3rd pers. masc. stative, see *Grammar* § 21.5.

³ Cf. also CCT 2, 47b:5-11, where P., arriving from Assur, told: "2 minas of gold that H. has invested with your father and which has been marked (*uddū*) in the name of *tamkārum* and belongs to the investors (*ummiānū*), that gold belongs to our father and to P."

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taken Elamma's and his brother's part (*qātum*) of the silver of their "paternal house" for a similar purpose.

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| <p><i>um-ma l-li-a A-šur-re-ší</i>
 <i>En-nam-A-šur ù Da-dí-a-/ma</i>
 <i>a-na E-la-ma qí-bi₄-ma</i>
 <i>5/6 ma-na LÁ 2 GÍN KÙ.B. ša KÙ</i>
 5 <i>A-la₁-hi-im ša li-bi₄ na-ru-qí-/kà</i>
 <i>ni-il₅-qé-a-šu-ma : ší-ma-am</i>
 <i>ni-iš-a-ma : Ku-na-a : ú-šé-bi₄-lá(A)-/kum</i>
 they to you.
 1 <i>ma-na KÙ.GI ša a-na A-lá-hi-im</i> (As for) the 1 mina of gold you yourself
 have
 <i>a-ta ša-áp-kà-tí-ni 1 2/3 ma-na KÙ.B.</i> invested with Ali-ahum, we collected
 10 <i>ni-il₅-qé-ma ší-ma-am</i> 1 2/3 mina of silver and made purchases
 <i>ni-iš-a-ma A-šur-lá-ma-sí ú-šé-ri-a-kum</i> and Aššur-lamassī has brought
 them to you.
 1/3 <i>ma-na KÙ.B. ša ší-im</i> 1/3 mina of silver of the price of the
 ANŠE.HI.A <i>ša a-na A-lá-hi-im</i> the donkeys you sent to
 <i>tù-šé-bi₄-lá-ni a-na li-bi₄</i> Ali-ahum has been added
 15 <i>lu-qú-tí-kà na-dí</i> to your merchandise;
 <i>En-nam-A-šur ù Šu-lštar</i> Ennam-Aššur and Šu-lštar, son of
 i.e. DUMU <i>Da-da-nim ú-šé-š[í]-ú-ni-kum</i> Dadānum, have shipped it off to you.
 rev. 20 <i>ma-na URUDU iš-tí DINGIR-ba-ni</i> We collected 20 minas of copper from
 8 <i>ma-na URUDU iš-tí *Ah-ma-a</i> Ilī-bāni and 8 minas of copper from
 Ahmaya
 20 <i>ni-il₅-qé-ma 4 TÚG šu-ru-tim</i> and we bought (with it) dark textiles;
 <i>ni-iš-a-ma En-nam-A-šur</i> Ennam-Aššur and
 <i>ù Šu-lštar DUMU Da-da-nim</i> Šu-lštar, son of Dadānum,
 <i>ub-lu-ni-kum a-šu-mi</i> have brought it to you. As for the silver
 KÙ.B. <i>ša É A.BA ša na-ru-uq</i> of the paternal house that is (in) the
 25 <i>A-la₁-hi-im ša ta-áš-pu-ra-ni</i> joint-stock capital of Ali-ahum, about
 <i>qá-at-kà ù qá-sú</i> which you wrote – Aššur-ṭāb took your
 <i>ša A-la₁-hi-im A-šur-DÙG</i> and Ali-ahum's part (and)
 <i>il₅-qé ší-ma-am iš-a-ma</i> he made purchases (with it)
 <i>ú-šé-ší né-nu</i> and shipped them off. We ourselves
 30 <i>mì-ma ú-lá ni-il₅-qé</i> did not receive/take anything.</p> | |
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Notes

8. The same investment of Elamma's in his brother's joint-stock fund is also mentioned in *4:1-3, and *35:6-8 mentions "5 1/3 minas of silver, your investment (*[š]ipkātika*), we took from Ali-ahum".

Comment

The words "silver *ša* silver of A., which is in your joint-stock fund" (lines 4-5) are difficult for syntactic reasons and because investments in a joint stock fund were always rated in gold, whereby 4 minas of silver yielded a share of 1 mina of gold (cf. for such a share line 8). That here silver is mentioned can mean silver as *equivalent* of the gold that A. had invested in Elamma's joint-stock fund, which would mean a

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withdrawal of capital from the fund to make purchases. But it may also mean (part of) the *yield* of the original investment, paid out in silver for making purchases (one never bought merchandise for gold). The odd figure of 48 shekels (l. 4) the first interpretation and suggests that A.'s share resulted from a division of their father's share in five parts. One may compare the division of an investment share of 2 minas of gold of Pūšu-kēn between his children, which also resulted in shares of 48 shekels, cf. Larsen 1977: 131 with note 41. But while the latter shares are in gold and therefore were actually split up, in our case A.'s share is in silver, which suggests that the investment had been withdrawn and paid out in silver, to be used for making purchases. This must also be the meaning of the two sentences of 8-11, where "1 mina of gold you have invested with A." somehow yielded "1 2/3 mina of silver we took for making purchases". Because 1 2/3 mina of silver is too little for 1 mina of gold, we have to assume that either only part of the 1 mina of gold was converted into silver or that the silver is the yield, the share in the profits made with this investment, so that "1 mina of gold" means "for/of the 1 mina of gold". The words "silver of the paternal house (which is part) of the joint-stock fund of A." (lines 24f.) reflect the same reality. They probably mean investments left behind by Iddin-Suen that presumably had not yet been divided and had flowed into Ali-ahum's joint-stock fund. The use of the expression "of the paternal house" (É A.BA) is typical for the situation not long after the death of a testator, when various assets were still undivided and joint property of the heirs, see Veenhof, forthcoming, § 4, with note 49. Here they are said to be silver and since a withdrawal of the capital (which entailed the conversion of a share in gold into silver) by both brothers is unlikely, the words probably refer to what these investments had yielded, of which both brothers would receive a part (*qātum*), which they could use to make purchases. When according to *35:6-8, 5 1/3 minas of silver "your *šipkātum*" with Ali-ahum was taken and used, the situation probably was the same, not a withdrawal of an investment, but collecting profit or dividend, to be used for the trade.

4. Kt 91/k 332 (1-189-91)

A memorandum written by Elamma (as is clear from a comparison on lines 1-4 with *3:8-9) which records that he has an investment share of 1 mina of gold in his brother's joint-stock capital and how he had acquired a similar one in that of his business associate Hinnāya.

	1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.GI	1 mina of gold
	<i>i-na na-ru-qí-šu</i>	I have as investment share
	<i>ša A-la-hi-im ni-a-/im</i>	in the joint-stock capital
	<i>ad-ma-ku</i>	of our Ali-ahum.
5	4 <i>ma-na</i> LÁ 10 GÍN	3 minas and 50 shekels
	KÙ.B. <i>ša-ru-pá-am</i>	of refined silver,
	<i>i-a-am</i>	belonging to myself,
l.e	<i>A-šūr-ma-lik</i>	I had Aššur-mālik,
rev.	DUMU <i>A-šūr-^dUTU</i>	son of Aššur-šamšī,
10	<i>ki-ma i-a-tí</i>	in my name
	<i>a-na Hi-na-a</i>	bring
	<i>ú-šé-bi₄-il₅-ma</i>	to Hinnāya and then
	<i>ù i-na té-er-tí-a</i>	and I also told
	<i>um-ma a-na-ku-ma</i>	Hinnāya

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15	<i>a-na °Hi-na-a-ma</i>	in my instruction:
	<i>a-na °na₂-ru-qí-kà</i>	"Take it for your
	<i>le-°qé₂-šu-ma</i>	joint-stock capital and book
u.e.	KÙ.GI <i>lu-up-<ta>-am</i>	the gold as being mine".
le.e	1 <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.GI	I have now an investment share
20	<i>ad-ma-ak-šu-/um</i>	with him of 1 mina of gold.

Notes

1, 20. Letter *3:9 describes the investment by means of the stative of *šapākum*, our memo with the stative of the verb *adāmum*, very common to express what somebody has invested and to which he is entitled, see the comment on text *5.

5. Was this a price between friends, because one normally pays 4 minas of silver for a share?

5. Kt 91/k 361 (1-218-91)

A memorandum about nine amounts of silver, specified for ownership and function, mostly owned as a deposit in a palace or as a share in a caravan. The writer/speaker in the first person singular (lines 23, 25) remains unknown, but he states that several amounts belong to Elamma, a few times together with other traders.

	2 <i>ma-na</i> 8 GÍN KÙ.B.	2 minas 8 shekels of silver (of)
	<i>E-lá-ma ù Ša-lim-a-hu-um</i>	Elamma and Šalim-ahum,
	1½ <i>ma-na</i> 3½ GÍN	33½ shekels (of silver) of
	<i>E-lá-ma i-na</i> ILLAT	Elamma from the caravan of
5	<i>Id-na-a : Ì-lí-a-lim</i>	Ilnaya, Ili-ālum and
	<i>ù A-šūr-i-dí i-na É.GAL-lim</i>	Aššur-idī have deposited in the
	<i>na-ad-ú 4⅔ ma-na</i>	palace. 4⅔ minas Elamma
	<i>E-lá-ma ù A-la₁-hu-um</i>	and Ali-ahum have deposited
	<i>i-na</i> ILLAT <i>Lá-qé-ep DUMU Qá-a-tim</i>	in the caravan of La-qēp, son
10	<i>na-ad-ú 2½ ma-na</i> 8 GÍN	of Qa'atum. 2 minas 28 shekels (of
	silver)	
	<i>E-lá-ma Hi-na-a</i>	Elamma, Hinnāya and
	<i>ù A-šūr-kà-šf-id</i>	Aššur-kašid have as share
	<i>i-na</i> ILLAT <i>Šu-A-nim</i>	in the caravan
l.e.	<i>ad-mu-ú</i>	of Šu-Anum.
rev.	15¼ GÍN <i>E-lá-ma</i>	15¼ shekels Elamma has as
16	<i>i-na</i> ILLAT <i>A-lá-hi-im ù Bu-šf-a</i>	share in the caravan of Ali-ahum
	<i>a-dí-im</i>	and Bušiya.
	2 <i>ma-na</i> 8 GÍN	2 minas 8 shekels Elamma
	<i>E-lá-ma i-na</i> ILLAT	has as share in the caravan of
20	<i>A-zu-za ù A-šūr-iš-tí-kál</i>	Azuza and Iliš-tikal.
	<i>a-dí-im</i> 4 <i>ma-na</i> LÁ 2 GÍN	4 minas minus 2 shekels
	<i>i-na</i> ILLAT <i>Pu-šu-ke-en₆</i>	I have as share in the
	<i>ad-ma-ku</i> (erasure)	caravan of Pūšu-kēn.
	<i>a-ha-ma</i> 13 GÍN <i>i-qá-tí</i>	Separately I will receive 13 shekels
25	<i>Lá-qé-ep a-lá-qé</i>	from the part of La-qēp.
	<i>ša</i> 3 LÁ ¼ TUG <i>ku-ta-nim</i>	For 2¾ <i>kutānu</i> -textiles

SIX BASIC DOCUMENTS (1-6)

5/6 *ma-na* 5 GÍN KÙ.B.
 u.e *i-na* ILLAT-*at* En-um-A-ššur
 DUMU Ba-sá-sá
 le.e ù ^d*En-líl-ba-ni i-na* É.GAL-*lim*
E-lá-ma a-dí-im

Elamma is entitled to 55 shekels
 of silver in the palace from
 the caravan of Ennum-Aššur,
 son of Basasa, and from
 Enlil-bāni.

Notes

7. To state that a person is entitled to part of the yield of a caravan, because he has contributed to or invested in it, the writer uses the statives of the verbs *nadā'um* and *adāmum*. *Nadā'um* in the stative refers to a deposit one has made, money to which one is entitled, but that has not yet been made available. It applies in particular to what local palaces have bought from a caravan and still have to pay out to its members, as in lines 6f. of our text, which can also be expressed by stating that a trader *ina ekallim adim*, as in lines 30f. of our text. The statement *ina ellitim ... nad'ū*, in lines 9f., is ambiguous; it could be abbreviated from *ina ellitim ina ekallim nad'ū*, or refer to silver the (leader of the) caravan has not yet paid out and still keeps in deposit. See also Kt n/k 528:15-17, quoted in OAI 174 note 471, where as the result of the palace pre-empting textiles "you have a deposit of 20 textiles in the palace (*ina ekallim nad'ātunu*); they will give us the balance of 15 textiles in the colonial office".

14. *Adāmum* (see Veenhof, *Lex.* s.v.) expresses what a person is entitled to, as in lines 30-34, silver from textiles shipped by a caravan and apparently pre-empted by the palace. From the verb a noun **idimtum* was derived, which occurs in the combination *bēl(ū) idmātim*, "entitled shareholders", see the note on *109:2.

Comment

See for the system of the caravans (*ellutum*), Ch. II, D. It is remarkable that of the men, who according to our text had organized caravans that were called after them, only Lā-qēp and Pūšu-kēn occur several times elsewhere in this capacity (see the list in OAI 165ff.). Šu-Anum (l. 13) features once in a text from a different archive excavated in 1991, in Kt 91/k 176, and the duo Aššuriš-tikal and Sukkaliya, attested in *19:20-21, also feature in CCT 4, 21b:5-6. That Lā-qēp, elsewhere a dozen times as leader of a caravan, apart from our text and *68a:18-19 never occurs as son of Qa'atum, is no reason to assume he was a different man. New names in our text and in the texts 51*-53* are:

Ali-ahum, *35:4

Ali-ahum + Bušiya (16) (the men served jointly as *hamuštu*-eponyms, cf. *328:1-3)

Azuza + Aššuriš-tikal, *5:20

Aššur-karwa + Aššur-imittī, *52:5-7

Ennam-Aššur s. Basasa + Ellil-bāni, *5:28-30

Ennam-Suen, *53:3

Idnāya, Ilī-ālum + Aššur-idī, *5:5-7

Ilī-ālum, *113:6, 11

Innāya + Aššur-taklāku, *47:28

Innāya + Šu-Nūnu, *47:9

Pilah-lštar, son of Uzua, *51:12.

It is not clear who wrote this text. Elamma is excluded, because he is referred to in the third person, unless Elamma himself was quoting from existing records that used the third person to refer to him and contained one item in direct speech.

6. Kt 91/k 533 (1-385-91)

<i>um-ma E-lá-ma-ma</i> <i>a-na A-šur-re-ší-ma</i> <i>a-na l-li-a ù ku-wa-tí</i> <i>A-lá-hu-um ú a-na-ku</i> 5 <i>ni-iš-pu-ra-ku-nu-tí</i> <i>um-ma né-nu-ma : i-na lu-qú-tim</i> <i>ša É a-bi₄-ni ki-iš-da-tí-ni</i> <i>ší-ma-am ša-ma-nim-ma</i> <i>a-na še-er A-lá-hi-im</i> 10 <i>ú i-a-tí še-bi₄-lá-nim</i> <i>mì-šu-um ši-ma-am lá ta-áš-[ta-ma-nim]</i> (rest of obv., l.e. and rev. missing) u.e. [] 1' <i>um-ma A-šur-re-ší-ma</i> <i>a-ma-lá té-er-tí A-lá-hi-im</i> le.e.[x x x t]ám i-na ba-áb : x [x x x]	Thus Elamma, <say> to Aššur-rēṣīt: Ali-ahum and I myself we wrote a letter to Iliya and to you in which we said: 'Make purchases with what accrues to us as (the yield of) the merchandise of your paternal house and send them to Ali-ahum and me'. Why have you failed to make purchases? Aššur-rēṣīt told (me): "In accordance with Ali-ahum's instructionin the gate"
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6. The words “to make purchases with the merchandise” are surprising, since normally “merchandise” (*luqūtum*) is bought in Assur and sent to Anatolia. *Luqūtum* literally “that what is acquired”, here must mean the yield, in silver, of goods that have been sold, which can be used for new purchases. In a few cases silver is actually called or ranges under *luqūtum* and one reads that silver and gold are bought (cf. *138:8-9, *šumma kaspam watram / ašta’am*, “if I have acquired additional silver”). It shows that our distinction between “merchandise” and “money” is too strict and that “to buy” means acquire by commercial exchange. Our letter may refer to transactions started by Elamma’s father (“the merchandise of our paternal house”) that were still running when he died and whose yield (in silver) became available to, accrued to (*kišdātum*) his sons.